

This house believes that true patriotism requires international mindedness

Motion: *This house believes that true patriotism requires international mindedness.*

PROPOSITION (PRO) TEAM

Speaker 1: Opening & Definition (Shaurya)

Role: Define the motion and set up the team line.

Speech:

"Respected judges, teachers, and fellow students. We, the Proposition, strongly support today's motion.

To love your country—to be a true patriot—means wanting the absolute best for it. But today, no country lives in isolation. Global issues like climate change, pandemics, and technology affect us all. Being internationally minded doesn't mean loving your country less; it means understanding the world better so you can protect and serve your country more effectively. True patriotism isn't about isolation; it's about active global leadership."

Speaker 2: Argument 1 – Global Problems Require Global Solutions (Sanvi)

Role: Focus on real-world cooperation.

Speech:

"Consider the biggest challenges our nation faces today: clean air, economic security, and technology. None of these stop at a national border. If a patriot wants to keep their country safe and prosperous, they must work with other nations.

International mindedness allows us to collaborate, share solutions, and bring scientific and economic benefits back home. A patriot who ignores the rest of the world leaves their country unprepared for global challenges."

Speaker 3: Argument 2 – Learning from Others Strengthens Home (Nihit)

Role: Focus on innovation and culture.

Speech:

"Being internationally minded helps us appreciate the best ideas from around the globe and use them to improve our own country. Whether it's adopting better education systems, eco-friendly energy solutions, or innovative technology, learning from other cultures makes our nation stronger.

Loving your country means wanting it to grow and improve—not staying stuck in the past because we refuse to look outside."

Speaker 4: Rebuttal & Summary (Aadhya)

Role: Counter Opposition points and reinforce Pro's main arguments.

Speech:

"The Opposition may argue that focusing on the world distracts from our local problems. But taking care of global issues *is* taking care of home.

When we cooperate on global healthcare, we protect local families. When we trade fairly, we boost local businesses. International mindedness gives us the tools to fix our domestic issues far better than isolation ever could."

Speaker 5: Final Conclusion (Eshika)

Role: Memorable closing statement.

Speech:

"To conclude: true patriotism is not about building higher walls to keep the world out; it is about building longer tables to lead the world forward. A true patriot works for a better home by contributing to a better world. Vote for the Proposition!"

OPPOSITION (CON) TEAM

Speaker 1: Opening & Definition (Tanvi)

Role: Reframe the motion and state the team line.

Speech:

"Respected judges, teachers, and fellow students. We, the Opposition, firmly oppose this motion.

Patriotism is a deep, specific commitment to one's own nation, its culture, its borders, and its people. While international cooperation is fine, saying that true patriotism *requires* international mindedness blurs the focus. A nation's primary duty—and a patriot's primary duty—is to look after its own citizens first."

Speaker 2: Argument 1 – Local Priorities Come First (Ishaan)

Role: Focus on immediate domestic needs.

Speech:

"Every nation has pressing internal challenges: poverty, local infrastructure, healthcare, and education. If our focus and resources are constantly spread across global issues, our local communities suffer.

True patriotism is rooted in immediate, local action: volunteering in your neighborhood,

supporting local businesses, and preserving local heritage. You cannot fix the world if you neglect your own backyard."

Speaker 3: Argument 2 – Protecting National Identity & Sovereignty (Deesha)

Role: Focus on culture and national independence.

Speech:

"Over-emphasizing global citizenship risks flattening unique cultures and national identities into one common global standard. Patriotism is about preserving our unique history, traditions, and values.

Furthermore, when international agreements conflict with national interests, a true patriot stands up for their country's independence rather than bowing to international pressure."

Speaker 4: Rebuttal & Summary (Adhvika)

Role: Counter Proposition points and reinforce Con's main arguments.

Speech:

"The Proposition claims that you must be globally minded to help your country. But history shows that national progress comes from focused local dedication.

Expecting every citizen to focus on global issues dilutes genuine local responsibility. Loyalty and care start at home; you don't need to focus on the whole world to be a proud, contributing citizen."

Speaker 5: Final Conclusion (Raagalina)

Role: Memorable closing statement.

Speech:

"To conclude: patriotism is a focused, deep love for one's home and people. Trying to make patriotism 'international' dilutes what makes it special. Let us care for our neighbors and our nation first. Vote for the Opposition!"